

Title: Contrary to what this sub believes defensive boots are very, very, very rarely optimal on ADC's

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

Let me preface this by saying that defensive boots are, very rarely, not a bad buy. Onto the post now though.

I see the post on the front page getting a LOT of traction. Let's get a few things out of the way

1. Defensive boots won't save you from assassins. They just won't. 35 armor or whatever the fuck it is and 12% auto damage isn't going to save you from an assassin even if they aren't fed. What will save you is positioning properly and forcing them to use their cd's on another enemy so you can safely approach a teamfight and do a LOT more damage because you built the proper boots.
2. Defensive boots bought early in lane harm your ability to lane. You're giving up aggressive combat stats for defensive combat stats. Aggressive combat stats help you manage the wave, punish enemy mistakes, and build towards your core items. You're setting yourself behind 800 gold minimum in order to negate like 20 damage per auto or be stunned by leona for 1.5 seconds instead of 2.5. I repeat, it is rarely optimal to buy defensive boots solely for lane phase.
3. Defensive boots are a bandaid fix that don't help stitch together your core issues with your gameplay. You'll win an extra game here and there while continuing to lose games due to your poor habits since you're strictly altering your builds and limiting your growth potential to play the game properly.

Study the game people. There's a reason it's very, very rare to see challenger/professional level adc players building defensive boots. I understand a lot of people will look at this and say, "Well, Tranimal, I'm only gold! You can't expect me to play like a challenger player!"

They're absolutely goddamn right. I can't expect it. Nobody can. But learn the game. Analyze it. Improve. If you see a Zed, Khazix, and Vayne on the enemy team look at them and instead of thinking "hey I need tabs" think "hey I need to let one of my teammates stall Zed and Khazix until their gap closers are down then I can abuse my range and position near my support/tanks so they can protect me from Vayne tumbling in to duel me on the side/backline of a fight"

This is not a mechanically intensive skill. You can do this with just your right mouse button. This is a mental skill that takes preparation and consistency to get used to. Work towards becoming the best player you can be and climb will come naturally as you improve.

Also, I'll reiterate, but there ARE times where defensive boots are viable. They're just very, very, very, very rare.

Edit: This post has caused a lot of conversation and there's no way I'll be able to respond to everyone with the time and detail that they deserve to be responded with. I'll still do my best but I'm gonna jot some general notes down here.

1. I'm not saying don't build defensive. Get an earlier PD. Go third/fourth item GA. Get a hex drinker or a wits end. BT exists. Adjust your rune tree. I'm a huge believer in Resolve tree secondary in some games against tougher comps. There's a lot of variation in the game and as some people have said, adjustment is a skill. My argument is that USUALLY your boots aren't the item that is in need of being adjusted.

2. I'm not saying to rely on your team to teamfight. A lot of people think I am and are saying their teams are unreliable and it's unreasonable to expect them to hold out long enough for tougher to deal with champions to use their cooldowns. My counterpoint is that your defensively adjusted build,

along with own champions abilities and kit are being ignored. If Zed w-flash-r?s you late you should have an item or two that makes up for the damage he?s losing from wasting cooldowns just to get to you. Then, on top of that, let?s take a look at Cait for example. If you?re playing well you?ll have counter play in your net, your trap, and potentially even your summoners being up. Unless he?s gigafed you have a chance of living. Kha? He e?s at you and you net. These things are a skill in league and, let?s be honest. 20 armor (it?s not even the 35 I said) is not going to make much of a difference.

3. You guys are all out here pointing at the lethality/magic pen numbers arguing how it?s valid. Yes armor directly counters lethality and same for m-pen. I know this. I thought most people did. It doesn?t change the fact that a zed combo, disregarding armor, one shots you usually mid-late because of the sheer amount of AD and ratios he has. On top of that 50(?) armor from chainvest is much more valuable. Pick that up earlier if you need too.

4. Yes Jhin doesn?t build greaves. I didn?t consider swifties defensive but he can build those or another defensive boot just fine. No lucidity aren?t defensive either, nor are they greaves. They?re fantastic on Ezreal. Please use common sense overall and apply it to discussions instead of nit-picking to try and ?win? a debate. The purpose for every single person here is to improve and have thoughtful discussion (or at least it should be).

5. Laning. Laning laning laning. I mean no offense here but a lot of people need to learn the basics of laning and wave manipulation if they don?t see how 35% attack speed makes a huge difference. Even to this day you?ll see high level players occasionally rush greaves. RUSH before their first item because of how much of a difference it makes in pushing their wave/holding their wave where they want it. Think of it this way. If you try to handle play dough with an oven mitt your hand is too big and overall too awkward to be precise and create what you want to create. That?s your base

attack speed. When you build attack speed, in terms of wave manipulation, you're taking the mitt off and allowing you to have greater control. Obviously champions kits still apply but attack speed is a MASSIVE tool. I talk about this a lot on my stream and love teaching this aspect of laning to people.

Thank you guys so much for the lovely discussion so far. Again, defensive boots are occasionally a decent option. But only very, very rarely.

Challenger

opinion:

https://www.reddit.com/r/summonerschool/comments/fck64c/contrary_to_what_this_sub_believes_defensive/fjctfqu/?utm_source=share&utm_medium=ios_app&utm_name=iossmf

Edit 2: Former professional player Maplestreet commented as well. Due to his insights, as well as some others I've read from other summoners and heard from friends, I've changed my stance on "never buy during lane". When you're bleeding resources and need to prevent a snowball from the enemy they can be warranted to allow your team to carry IF that is the win condition

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 296]

More important is picking up a defensive item early rather than boots

buy a chain vest for GA later if the ad midlaner has snowballed and one shotting you

[Comment 2 | Score: 91]

It's simple... and this applies to any champions that can greatly benefit from the attack speed of berserker greaves (mostly ADCs but also champs like yasuo, trynda, etc).

* Merc treads against a heavy AP comp = BAD, just buy greaves and wits end/maw if you need MR.

* Merc treads against a heavy CC comp = GOOD (knockups and slows don't count as heavy CC. Think of stuff like leona, elise, ahri, varus). This is an ok situation where you can consider merc treads instead of greaves.

* Tabi against multiple assassins comp = BAD (assassins rarely ever use autoattacks and the armor from tabi is negligible. If the enemy zed/talon focuses you and doesnt fuck up, you are dead regardless of your boots choice). Buy early stopwatch and then GA

* Tabi against multiple AA based champions comp = GOOD (Irelia, kindred, Corki, Senna, Yasuo, double/triple ADC comps). Again, this is a good situation where you can consider tabi instead of greaves.

Correct itemization against assassins as an ADC is phantom dancer after your big first item (usually IE/ER/BOTRK), early stop watch, GA 3rd item and possibly a BT 4th.

Personally, I suck as ADC but I think zerk greaves is the way to go in 99% of the games. Positioning is the key when you play ADC not tiny defensive bonuses from your boots. If you are getting hit by CC then you are positioning wrong unless its CC from 2 screens away like leona's ult or ashe's arrow but if thats the case then you should have cleanse/qss and not merc treads. Also if you are always getting deleted by that talon then you are also doing something wrong or the talon is really fucking good. (Im a talon main and I always find a way to reach ADCs no matter how good they position :p)

Edit: I expanded a bit since I noticed this comment is getting some attention, gl all!

[Comment 3 | Score: 134]

People are just sick of their soloq teammates building 6 offensive items every game, so they overcomplain here. The problem is that those soloq teammates don't check subreddits like this, so in the end, the soloq players still build 6 offensive items while /r/summonerschool players build 6 defensive items.

[Comment 4 | Score: 148]

Like I said always buy greaves if you are semi competent

[Comment 5 | Score: 17]

Stopwatch works wonders too. Or get a earlier PD. There?s tons of better options